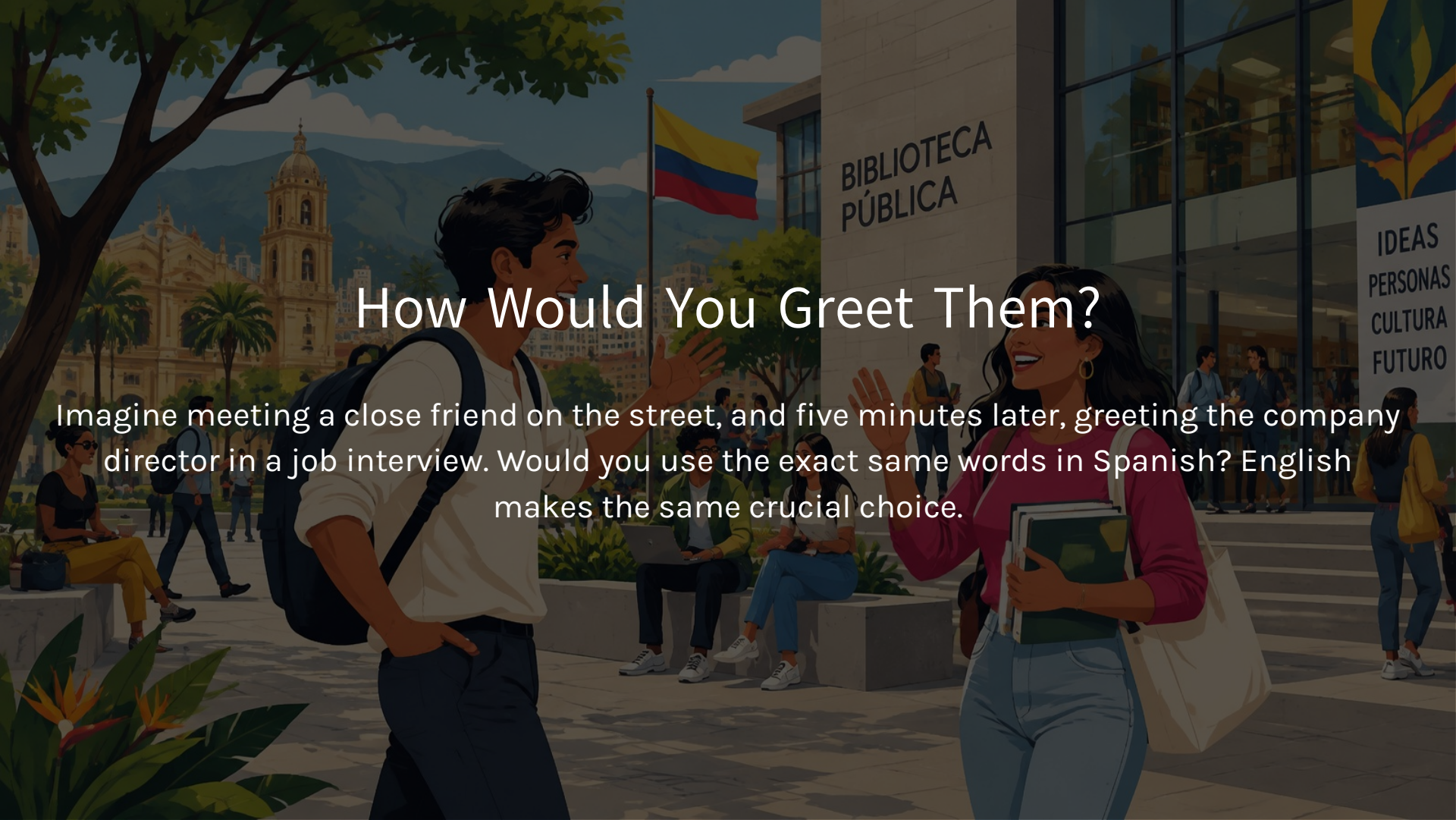


Greetings and Goodbyes

Formal and informal English communication for everyday life



An illustration of a vibrant city street scene. In the foreground, a young man with dark hair, wearing a white shirt and a backpack, is walking towards the right. A young woman with long dark hair, wearing a pink shirt and blue jeans, is walking towards the left, holding several books and a white tote bag. They are both smiling and gesturing with their hands as if they are about to greet each other. In the background, there is a large, modern building with a sign that reads "BIBLIOTECA PÚBLICA". To the left of the library, there is a flagpole with the Colombian flag. Further back, there is a large, ornate church with a dome and a mountain range in the distance. The scene is set during the day with a clear sky and some clouds. The overall style is a colorful, stylized illustration.

How Would You Greet Them?

Imagine meeting a close friend on the street, and five minutes later, greeting the company director in a job interview. Would you use the exact same words in Spanish? English makes the same crucial choice.

Learning Objectives

1

Identify Social Register

Distinguish between formal and informal greetings and goodbyes in English.

2

Select by Social Context

Choose the appropriate expression for workplace, academic, and friendly settings.

3

Build a Mini-Exchange

Greet a partner, state your name using "My name is...", and conclude politely.

Key Vocabulary



Hello

A universal word used to greet someone at any time of day.



Goodbye

A conventional phrase used when parting or ending a conversation.



Formal

Polite language suitable for official, academic, or professional situations.



Informal

Casual language used with familiar friends, peers, and close family.

Warm-up: Spanish to English



¡Hola! → Hi / Hey

Used constantly in Colombia among classmates and peers. Both words express friendly, immediate warmth.



Buenos días → Good morning

The standard polite greeting from early morning until noon in formal and business environments.



¿Cómo te va? → How's it going?

A natural informal inquiry about current life. In Colombia, like asking "¿Todo bien?".



¡Chao! → Bye / See ya!

Universal casual sign-offs used when leaving friends, classmates, or trusted family members.

Casual Social Greetings

INFORMAL REGISTER

Connecting with Friends

Informal greetings establish immediate ease. Use "**Hi!**", "**Hey!**", and "**Hey there!**" with people your age, friends, and family.

- **Hi!** — The most common everyday greeting.
- **Hey!** — Very casual; best for friends you already know.
- **How are you doing?** — A warm, natural question to ask how someone feels.



More Casual Openers



What's Up?

Means "¿Qué tal?" or "¿Qué hay de nuevo?". A natural reply is simply *"Not much"* or *"All good!"*.



Long Time No See!

Expresses excitement when seeing an acquaintance you have not met for weeks or months: *¡Cuánto tiempo sin verte!*



How's It Going?

Pronounced fluidly as a single phrase. Answer with *"Great!"*, *"Pretty good!"*, or *"I'm doing well."*

Informal Greetings

You meet your university classmate at a cafe. Which greeting is the most natural and informal?

1.

How do you do, sir?

2.

It is a great honor to meet you.

3.

Good evening, respected colleague.

4.

Hey! How's it going?

Informal Greetings



You meet your university classmate at a cafe. Which greeting is the most natural and informal?

1. How do you do, sir?
2. It is a great honor to meet you.
3. Good evening, respected colleague.
4. Hey! How's it going?





Formal Professional Greetings

Formal greetings show respect at work and school. Use **"Hello"**, **"Good morning"**, and **"Nice to meet you"** with clients, doctors, and teachers.



Key Context

Use formal greetings when meeting people in professional settings.

Greetings by Time of Day

12:00 PM – 6:00 PM

Good afternoon

Used throughout the
post-lunch working day.

6:00 AM – 12:00 PM

Good morning

Standard respectful
greeting from dawn
until midday.

6:00 PM – Night

Good evening

Used when arriving or
greeting people after
dusk.

First-Time Meeting Phrases

Polite Introductions

When you are introduced to a colleague or client for the first time, acknowledge the introduction immediately with one of these key formal formulas:

- **"Nice to meet you."** – Friendly and widely accepted in business.
- **"It's a pleasure to meet you."** – Extra polite; great for interviews.
- **"How do you do?"** – Traditional formal greeting; reply with the same phrase.



Matching Greetings

Match the words with the definitions

What's up?

Casual, friendly greeting for peers and friends

Hey there!

Polite expression when meeting someone formally

**It's a pleasure to
meet you.**

Formal morning greeting before 12:00 PM

Good morning

Informal check-in asking what is new

Matching Greetings

Match the words with the definitions



What's up?

A

Casual, friendly greeting for peers and friends

Hey there!

B

Polite expression when meeting someone formally

It's a pleasure to meet you.

C

Formal morning greeting before 12:00 PM

Good morning

D

Informal check-in asking what is new

Casual Goodbyes

Parting from Friends

When concluding an informal conversation, native speakers rarely use stiff goodbyes. Instead, they use expressions that imply future contact:

- **"Bye!" / "See you!"** – Quick, natural daily farewells.
- **"See you later!" / "See you soon!"** – Perfect when you will meet again.
- **"Take care!"** – Warm sign-off showing personal care.
- **"Catch you later!" / "See ya!"** – Ultra-informal youth and peer slang.



Formal Partings

Professional closings for the workplace.



Polite Farewell Expressions

In business and academic environments, leave a lasting positive impression with polite closings:

- **"Goodbye."** – Simple, courteous, and respectful.
- **"Have a good day." / "Have a good evening."** – Courteous wishes to clients and coworkers.
- **"It was nice speaking with you."** – Validates the conversation you just completed.
- **"I look forward to seeing you again."** – Expresses anticipation for future collaboration.

Crucial Contrast: Night vs. Evening



Good Evening = Greeting

When you arrive at an event, dinner, or class after 6:00 PM, say "**Good evening**". It opens the interaction.



Good Night = Farewell

Never use "Good night" to say hello! "**Good night**" means goodbye at the end of the evening or before going to bed.

Evening Greeting Check

You arrive at an 8:00 PM business dinner and greet your boss with 'Good night!'.



TRUE



FALSE



Be ready to explain your thinking.

Evening Greeting Check



You arrive at an 8:00 PM business dinner and greet your boss with 'Good night!'.



TRUE



FALSE



 **Why is that?**

'Good night' is only used when departing or going to sleep, never as a greeting upon arrival.

Watch: Greeting in Real Situations



Introducing Yourself: My Name Is...

The Universal Pattern

Once you greet someone, state your name using this core building block:

"Hello. My name is Camila. Nice to meet you."

You can also say "**I'm Camila**" in casual situations. In both cases, follow with *"Nice to meet you"* to invite a warm connection.



Step-by-Step Mini-Exchange



1. Greet

Select formal or informal based on your partner.

2. Introduce

State your name clearly: *"My name is..."*

3. Part

Conclude with *"Have a good day"* or *"See you!"*

Workplace Greeting

Listen to the audio and answer the questions



A Formal Encounter

Play audio

- 1 What time of day does this conversation take place?
- 2 What is the woman's name?
- 3 Which formal parting phrase does Elena use?
- 4 Is this conversation formal or informal?

Workplace Greeting

Check your answers below



A Formal Encounter

 Play audio

1 In the morning (they greet with 'Good morning')

2 Elena Gomez

3 Have a wonderful day

4 Formal (they use titles, last names, and polite expressions)

Informal Dialogue Example



Carlos: "Hey, Andrea! How are you doing?"

Andrea: "Hi Carlos! I'm doing great, thanks. Catch you later!"

Carlos: "See ya! Take care!"

Order the Dialogue

Arrange these parts of an introduction into the natural spoken order:

Have a great day. Goodbye!

My name is Ana Gomez.

Good morning.

It is a pleasure to meet you.

Order the Dialogue

Arrange these parts of an introduction into the natural spoken order:



Good morning.

1

My name is Ana Gomez.

2

It is a pleasure to meet you.

3

Have a great day. Goodbye!

4

Formal vs. Informal Matrix



Formal Greetings

- Good morning / afternoon
- Hello
- How do you do?
- Nice to meet you



Informal Greetings

- Hi! / Hey!
- Hey there!
- How are you doing?
- What's up?



Formal Goodbyes

- Goodbye
- Have a good day
- Nice speaking with you
- Until next time



Informal Goodbyes

- Bye! / See you!
- See you later / soon
- Take care!
- Catch you later!

Progress Check: "I Can..."

Self-Assessment

Reflect on your personal progress for
Session 1 of our module:



Can-Do Statement

*"I can greet people and say goodbye
using formal and informal
expressions."*

You now possess the foundational register
tools for everyday English interaction.

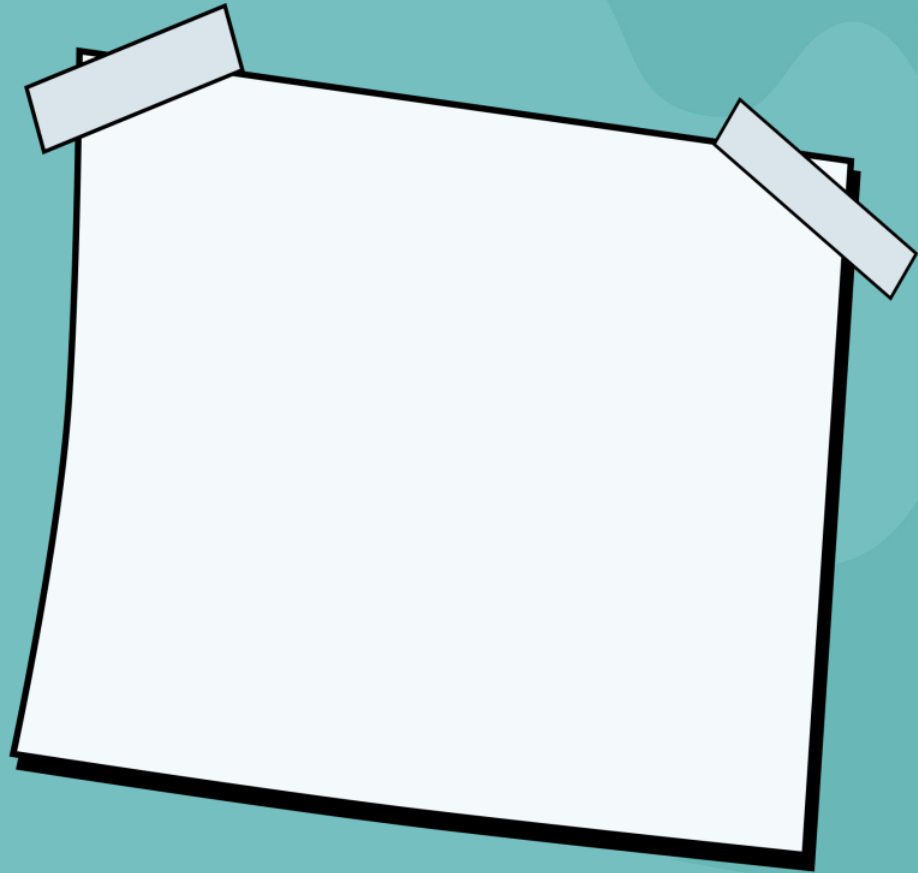


Mini-Dialogue Practice

Create a short 3-line dialogue. Choose either formal or informal register. Include a greeting, your name with 'My name is...', and a polite goodbye.

What you'll need: 🎨 🖋️

Your notebook or device



Check Your Understanding



You are meeting your new company director at 9:00 AM on your first day of work. Which greeting, introduction, and goodbye would you choose, and why?

Check Your Understanding



You might have said...

A strong response uses formal expressions: 'Good morning, sir. My name is [Your Name]. It is a pleasure to meet you.' At departure: 'Have a good day. Goodbye.' This shows respect and professional decorum.